

Karthik Acharya

Global Total Rewards & Workforce
Cost Strategy Leader



Personal details

-  Karthik Acharya
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-  Chennai, India
-  Indian

Skills

- Workday
- SAP HR
- PeopleSoft
- AI & Workforce Analytics
- Power BI
- Microsoft Office Suite
- CoPilot Studio
- HR Strategy
- M&A Integration
- Total Rewards (C&B)
- HR Technology
- AI in HR
- Workforce Planning

Profile

Driving enterprise-scale compensation strategy, cost optimization, and AI-led HR transformation across global organizations (US, Europe, APAC)

Global HR leader with 16+ years of experience specializing in **Total Rewards, Workforce Cost Optimization, and HR Analytics** across multinational organizations for **5,000–10,000+ employees globally**, delivering **\$5M+ in cost savings** and improving workforce efficiency through data-driven decision-making. Expert in **benchmarking, executive compensation, pay-for-performance models, incentive design, global job architecture, and multi-country rewards governance**, with strong alignment to business profitability and growth. Recognized for integrating **AI and analytics into HR**, enabling predictive workforce planning and operational efficiency gains of 30%+.

CORE EXPERTISE

- Global Total Rewards Strategy (C&B)
- Workforce Cost Optimization & Budgeting
- Executive Compensation & Incentive Design (STI/LTI)
- Pay-for-Performance Frameworks
- HR Analytics & Predictive Workforce Planning
- HR Transformation & AI Automation
- Global Job Architecture & Benchmarking (WTW, Mercer, AON)
- M&A Integration & Workforce Transitions
- HR Systems (Workday, SAP, PeopleSoft, Power BI)

Education

International MBA

Sep 2018 - Sep 2019

Emlyon Business School, France

- Specialized in International Strategy & Entrepreneurship (Grade A)
- Exchange Programs: 1) Lancaster University, UK (April - May 2019) 2) Oulu University, Finland (Feb 2019)
- Projects: 1) Jan 2019 - United Nations (Geneva, Switzerland) - Study the International Negotiations on Commerce between International Nations. 2) Feb 2019 - Oulu University, Finland - Research and Study on Drone Safety, AI for weather detection, and electric aviation technologies.
- French Language Studies at Alliance Francais and Coup de Pouce Universite - From Oct 2019 - July 2020
- Part-time employment: Student Ambassador and Recruiter at emlyon business school, Lyon, France - April 2020 - Feb 2021

PG Diploma in e-Business (MBA)

Sep 2004 - Apr 2006

Welingkar Institute of Management, India

- Cultural Secretary of the student association

BSc - Computer Science

Aug 2001 - Apr 2004

Hindustan College of Arts & Science, Chennai

- Sports and Academic Gold Medalist

HR (People) Analytics

DE&I

Performance Management

Job Evaluation

Incentives & Bonus

Job Evaluation

Benchmarking

Languages

English 

French 

Hobbies

 Theatre

 Writing

 AI Automations

Employment

Associate Director – HR (Head of Global Total Rewards, Analytics & HR Systems) Mar 2021 - Jul 2025
[GEP Worldwide, Remote \(Chennai\)](#)

Led enterprise-wide Total Rewards strategy and workforce cost management for a **5,000+ employee global organization (India, US, EMEA, APAC)**

- Delivered **10+ global compensation and performance cycles**, including promotions, bonuses, and incentive payouts across regions
- Managed multi-million-dollar workforce budgets, aligning compensation strategy with business growth and profitability
- Achieved **\$800K+ annual cost savings** through AI-led automation of HR workflows and analytics
- Improved **workforce planning accuracy by 25%** using predictive analytics and Power BI dashboards
- Led global benchmarking initiatives (Mercer, WTW, Aon), redesigning pay structures for competitiveness and cost efficiency
- Designed and implemented **pay-for-performance frameworks**, strengthening performance differentiation
- Directed HR technology transformation (AI tools - CoPilot, LeenaAI)
- **Leadership: Member of HR Leadership group**
- Advised senior leadership and co-founder on HR strategy, cost optimization, and transformation initiatives
- Owned rewards governance across multiple geographies with compliance and consistency

Consultant - HR - Sales Specialist Jan 2017 - Jul 2018
[DXC Technology \(Erstwhile HP Enterprise\), Bangalore](#)

- Managed 15+ global workforce transitions, including **two ~\$1B deals**, ensuring 100% compliance and over 75% retention
- Successfully transitioned 5,000+ employees across 20 countries (including ARD/TUPE) with **85% key talent retention** and/or assimilation

Senior Manager - HR - Compensation & Benefits Feb 2016 - Jan 2017
[Altisource, Bangalore](#)

- Led compensation cycles for 10,000+ employees, annual revisions, bonus cycles, and incentive payouts.
- Managed Salary fitments and worked with immigration for global mobility of employees from India to the US, UK and Luxembourg
- Managed a team of 6 conducting benchmarking, new hire comp with ESOPs, creating compensation scales/ranges and managing governance

Manager - HR - Compensation & Benefits Jan 2013 - Feb 2016
[Exilant Technologies, Bangalore](#)

- Spearheaded compensation frameworks for 2,000+ employees, improving the payscale for employees (All fixed components), resulting in a massive boost to the glassdoor rating of the company
- Managed compensation cycles (4 cycles) including incentives and bonus payouts, creating and managing budgets with business heads and CFO
- Salary fitments, and working with immigration in the US for global mobility of employees from India and Singapore
- Singapore - Worked with MOM representatives for employee mobility and salary pay structure, tying up with local agencies for smooth onsite transition of employees

Integration Specialist - HR - M&A Division

Aug 2011 - Jan 2013

Accenture, Bangalore

- Program managed Accenture's largest **acquisition (Zenta, 3.7k employees, \$250Mn+)**; 100% integration within 6 months.
- Ensured **80% employee retention** post-integration across multiple global acquisitions.

Deputy Manager - HR - Compensation & Benefits

Jun 2010 - Aug 2011

Hexaware Technologies, Mumbai

- Managed the annual salary revision cycle including compensation revision, incentives & bonuses.
- Conceptualized, Designed and Led the Company Car lease **policy implementation**, including finance approval, and vendor negotiation

Executive - HR - Compensation & Benefits

Aug 2006 - Jan 2010

Wipro Technologies, Bangalore

- Managed over 4 comp revision cycles (**Europe, US & CA and APAC of over 10k employees**) - from budget allocation to finalization
- Designed and Managed a sales incentives payout portal for 2k+ salesforce employees
- Supported payroll integration during M&A activities (Stationed in Germany and Austria), ensuring continuity of monthly pay and HR compliance during transitions (EU Labor Law - ARD)

Key Achievements

C&B, M&A and HR Transformation

Focusing on HR Delivery, Cost Efficiency and Technology

- Career Annual Revision Cycles delivered - 20+ (Including Incentives, Variable Pay, Bonuses payout)
- Seamlessly integrated a \$250M acquisition (3,700 employees) at Accenture.
- Delivered \$5M+ in cost savings via compensation redesign and automation.
- Deployed AI-enabled HR systems (LeenaAI, CoPilot), improving operational efficiency by 30%.

Certifications

GPHR®

Jan 2016

SHRM-SCP™

Mar 2016